

Social Sciences TA Evaluation for Benson, Andrew Glen ECON 145E LEC A (62240), Winter Qtr 2019

Responses: 43/79 (54.43%)

ATTENDANCE

1. How often did you attend discussion sections?

- 1** Never
- 0** Once
- 0** 2 - 3 times
- 0** 4 - 5 times
- 4** 6 - 7 times
- 10** 8 times
- 28** More than 8 times

2. How often did you meet with the T.A., outside of the section time, to discuss the course material?

- 13** Never
- 11** Once
- 11** 2 - 3 times
- 4** 4 - 5 times
- 0** 6 - 7 times
- 0** 8 times
- 2** More than 8 times

PRESENTATION

3. T.A. was competent in course material:

- 0** 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 3** 1 (Among Worst)
- 0** 2
- 4** 3
- 8** 4 (OK or Average)
- 6** 5
- 9** 6
- 13** 7 (Among Best)

4. T.A. was able to make presentations clearly:

- 0** 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 4** 1 (Among Worst)
- 2** 2
- 2** 3
- 15** 4 (OK or Average)
- 4** 5
- 8** 6
- 8** 7 (Among Best)

5. T.A. was responsive to students:

- 0** 0 (N/A or Unsure)
- 4** 1 (Among Worst)
- 0** 2
- 4** 3
- 9** 4 (OK or Average)
- 3** 5
- 6** 6
- 17** 7 (Among Best)

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6. T.A. was able to integrate the lecture and discussion material:

0 0 (N/A or Unsure)
6 1 (Among Worst)
5 2
5 3
10 4 (OK or Average)
3 5
7 6
7 7 (Among Best)

7. T.A. was present and on time for discussion sections/office hours:

1 0 (N/A or Unsure)
4 1 (Among Worst)
0 2
0 3
4 4 (OK or Average)
2 5
7 6
24 7 (Among Best)

8. The discussion sections were useful to the success of the course:

0 0 (N/A or Unsure)
8 1 (Among Worst)
8 2
2 3
6 4 (OK or Average)
5 5
5 6
9 7 (Among Best)

9. I would expect another course with this T.A. to be:

2 0 (N/A or Unsure)
10 1 (Among Worst)
3 2
4 3
9 4 (OK or Average)
3 5
5 6
7 7 (Among Best)

EFFECTIVENESS

10. Rate your T.A.'s general teaching effectiveness:

3 Poor
2 Inadequate
7 Less than adequate
12 Adequate
5 More than adequate
7 Very good
7 Excellent

COMMENTS

11. *<No question text>*

1. What were the strongest points of the TA in discussion section or office hours?

- Always willing to help students and make extra time to meet with them
 - Clear
 - discussion of homework assignments and prep for exams
 - Explains everything very clearly and always goes above and beyond when helping people
 - extremely responsible!!!!
 - he is active and take responsibility
 - he takes really good care to whoever comes to ask questions
 - He was very good in helping for the homework
 - His ability to simply explain step by step how to solve problems not just a specific one but in general
 - I didn't see any strong points.
 - My TA really cared about the environment and he knows a lot of chemistry behind it. Hes a nice guy. I can tell hes trying. But if hes going to give us homework thats worth 15 percent, about chemistry and unrelated to the concept of lecture. He should teach us how to solve it and not waste our time doing the homework, thats not going to be on the exam. What im saying is, his homework should be based on the effectiveness of his teaching during discussion. He needs to go teach the material if hes going to give us homework on it.
 - n/a
 - NONE. WORST TA EVER. AND I DON'T MEAN AT UCI.
 - NO strongest points of this TA.
 - Very proactive, tried to get students involved and interested in the discussions through different motivation techniques.
 - Went over homework
 - 27 blank answer(s).
2. Do you have any recommendations for your TA that would help that person be a more effective TA in the future?
- As far as it goes for the homework it was non related to the lecture content and too long for its actual weight on the final grade.
 - Change the homework
 - Create homework assignments that are actually relevant to the class syllabus, do not change the professor's exams in the interests of straying from the content taught in class, do not mix students exam grades and then upload them without double checking.
 - Do not post the hardest homework.
 - Explain and teach students the material necessary to pass the class rather than just writing problems and answering them on the board. Also, create homework that will prepare us for the test.
 - He makes the exam too tricky and changes the original version of midterm from the professor.
 - he needs go straight to explanation, not just give hint and go around to give answer
 - He needs to stop acting like he's the professor in lecture and in discussion. When the professor is lecturing, Andrew shouldn't interrupt to correct him. I find that very disrespectful. He needs to stop being bossy with the students and including the professor. For example, I witnessed Andrew telling the professor to start the class in a rude way, everyone was shocked because he raised his voice at him. The professor was only waiting for 3 mins for any late comers and for some students to settled in to start the lecture. Andrew needs to work on being more welcoming because his ugly attitude makes it hard to approach for help.

- Hm let's see. 1) Use discussion as a means to prepare students for the midterm/final and help students review material they are unclear with, instead of having fun at home creating useless 8-10 hours long, difficult homeworks for students that are NOT on the midterm or final exam. Having 5% of it be on the exams and then having the extremely long hw due ONE lecture before the exam is ludicrous. If you're going to be sadistic, at least be somewhat reasonable and make it due a week beforehand so people actually have time to study. No wonder the midterm scores were terrible. I got a very high score on the midterm, but that's not the point and the HW was not helpful at all. The HW was basically bitch work that was a waste of everyone's time and took away time from students being able to study. 2) Don't be a dick and change questions/answers and make them ridiculously hard on the midterm to the point only FOUR (or six, don't quite remember) out of 75 students get that question right, especially (?) without the professor's consent. When this topic was brought up in the next lecture, the professor seemed genuinely confused and said that the TA told the professor in an email that he'd be making "syntax"/"English" revisions to the midterm. Yeah, sure. The professor even continuously reassured the class after that the TA would not be able to touch the questions on the final created by the professor. Like seriously? How the hell do you not have anything better to do as a PHD student? 3) Admit that you screwed up on these stupid homeworks instead of trying to save face last minute by replacing the professor's extra credit questions on the final with YOUR dumb homeworks, just so we "can't say that the midterm/finals were not related to the homeworks and give me a terrible review." Seriously? Your homework isn't related to the class. You ARBITRARILY made it related to the class in an effort to make your reviews less negative. Additionally, I'm 100% sure the revised extra credit questions are going to be way more difficult than the extra credit questions the professor originally intended to have us do. I would bet \$1 trillion dollars on that if I could. So in the end, you're screwing us over AGAIN. If anything, this review is much worse because the TA refused to just admit that maybe the homeworks weren't so useful after all, but remained stubborn until the very end and screwed us over not once but twice. 4) Talking about screwing us over. Another recommendation would be to do YOUR job properly instead of wasting time dicking around and making students' lives miserable. Over half of the discussion time is spent talking about topics that are NOT relevant to lecture at all or the exams, or reviewing the homework which is also NOT relevant to the class/exams. You're a teaching assistant. Nobody cares if you thought excess relative risk was an important part of Chapter x that was not included in the book or lecture, so you arbitrarily decided to put it on the homework in a 10-week course that goes by extremely fast and waste valuable discussion time. Instead of dicking around like that, how about making sure that the gradebooks are correct? This was the first time (that I know of) where a TA screwed up the midterm grades. THIRTEEN out of seventy-five students had their midterm grades swapped with someone else's. This caused extreme, unnecessary stress on those 13 students. Some people got much lower grades than they got, and thus were extremely stressed out about it. And some people got extremely high grades initially in their gradebook, only to realize a week later that they got possibly 1-4 letter grades lower. I was pretty upset about receiving my initial score (which was fairly low) and thought I had done a good amount better than that. It stressed me out a lot since I'm trying to maintain a high GPA for grad school, and doing "poorly" on a midterm that I studied hard for and thought I did fairly alright on was demoralizing. Fortunately, some student caught the mistake in office hours and the scores were corrected, with my new score being a lot higher. If that student hadn't come to office hours, it's completely plausible that the mistake would have went by unnoticed and some people would have been extremely screwed over while those who did not study at all could have gotten very good grades that they did not earn. This is seriously the biggest screw-up a TA could do. I honestly wouldn't even be even 5% as mad if the TA were actually genuinely trying to help the students out in discussion, very helpful (like some of my other TAs), and made an honest mistake. In fact, I wouldn't be mad at the TA AT ALL. I'm only pissed

off because the TA blatantly wastes our study time, wastes our discussion times, dicking around creating insanely long homework that's useless which also probably took hours and hours of his own time that he could have used to do his job properly, etc. Yeah, too busy screwing us over to make sure our grades are correct. Wonderful. Teaching at its finest.

- Integrate the lecture and discussion!
- I would make the homework a bit more relevant to the lecture and exam content
- Made the test more difficult on purpose. Homework was extremely difficult and did not correlate with the lectures.
- make easier test questions
- make the homework more coherent to help student prepare for the exams.
- The homework is unnecessarily hard
- The ta did more teaching than the teacher. So it made the class objectives and dynamics kind of awkward
- to optimaize time and important materials
- try and integrate the material and the homework more along the lines of the professors lecturing
- try not to focus a lot on non relevant details that only cast doubts and create confusion, in addition try to not create too interpretative discussion on questions
- Try to relate homework to the lecture, even through lectures weren't super efficient or helpful it would've been nice to have discussion go over concepts and math that was shown in class instead of work that didn't really relate to what was in the textbook
- Why make the material harder for students! The curriculum you taught did not match with the professors. A majority of the class did not like the homework
- 22 blank answer(s).